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THE DOWNFALL OF AN AWESOME FRANCHISE!

RESIDENT EVIL Operation Raccoon City

Resident Evil: Operation Raccoon City continues in the universe of Resident Evil 2 and 3. Naturally, the expectations from the game are high. Add to the mix the element of team-based shooting and we have a game that could give the likes of Left for Dead a run for their money. So where did it go wrong? Read on.

The story takes place during the initial virus epidemic in Raccoon City. You join the ranks of the Umbrella Security Service (USS) with the objective of destroying all evidence of the company's involvement in the outbreak.

The story could've been really interesting had there been relatable characters and a little back-story. In the offline single player version, you don the role of a faceless player and hence, it's hard to derive any form of attachment to the characters. The progression is random and will leave new comers in the dark.

All things said and done, a bad game can still be rescued by its gameplay elements. Unfortunately, the gameplay in *Raccoon City* is appalling. We recommend playing the game with friends online (There are twelve playable characters in the game, with six characters for each side), as the offline AI comrades are downright useless. We were surprised when one of these comrades deployed a heeling grenade at the right time for once.

The game is essentially a third person shooter where you progress from point A to point B killing everything that comes in your way. It sounds like a nice progression mix when you're reminded that the enemies vary between zombies and soldiers but the experience is nothing but sheer frustration.

It's satisfying to take out a zombie with one headshot, but the rest of the shooting mechanics feel uneven. In your arsenal, you have the option of a handgun, an assault rifle and a bunch of grenades.

To take cover in the game, all you need to do is go close to any object and your character will take cover automatically. This system takes a little time to get used to, as it's simpler to press a button to get in and out of cover.

There are the occasional set piece moments, which are generally the high point of third person shooters and provide a break from the monotony. The set piece moments in *Raccoon City* are lackluster when compared to the likes of *Gears of War*.

The highlight of any Resident Evil game has always been the infected zombies and their reactions. In *Raccoon City*, their presence doesn't go beyond the tried and tested formula. The game should take some serious inspiration from games such as *Dead Space 2*.

The environments don't showcase anything worth boasting about also. You're either in a corridor of some building or in an open courtyard. There

are no moments where you'd want to stop to take a look at the environment.

The faces of the characters you don too are covered and don't provide any relatable emotions. There's nothing to get you attached to your character apart from a nickname and character class. ✨

Verdict

Resident Evil: Operation Raccoon City, even if borrowed heavily from other games in the genre, could've been worthwhile. If you're in the market to scare your pants off, look at *Dead Space 2*, *Left For Dead* or even *Alan Wake*. TPS enthusiasts check out the *Uncharted* franchise, *Socom* and *Gears of War*. It's difficult to recommend this game even to a Resident Evil veteran.

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- » **Developer:** Slant Six Games
- » **Publisher:** Capcom
- » **Genre:** Third Person Shooter
- » **Platforms:** PC, PS3 and Xbox 360
- » **Price:** ₹2,999 (MRP)

